

## Lesson 03 Demo 01

# Integrating n8n for Automated Customer Support Ticket Routing

**Objective:** To build an n8n-based ticket routing workflow that captures support emails, prioritizes them with simple rules, and logs to Google Sheets to reduce missed or delayed responses by centralizing intake and highlighting urgent cases

**Tools required:** n8n, Gmail, Google Sheets

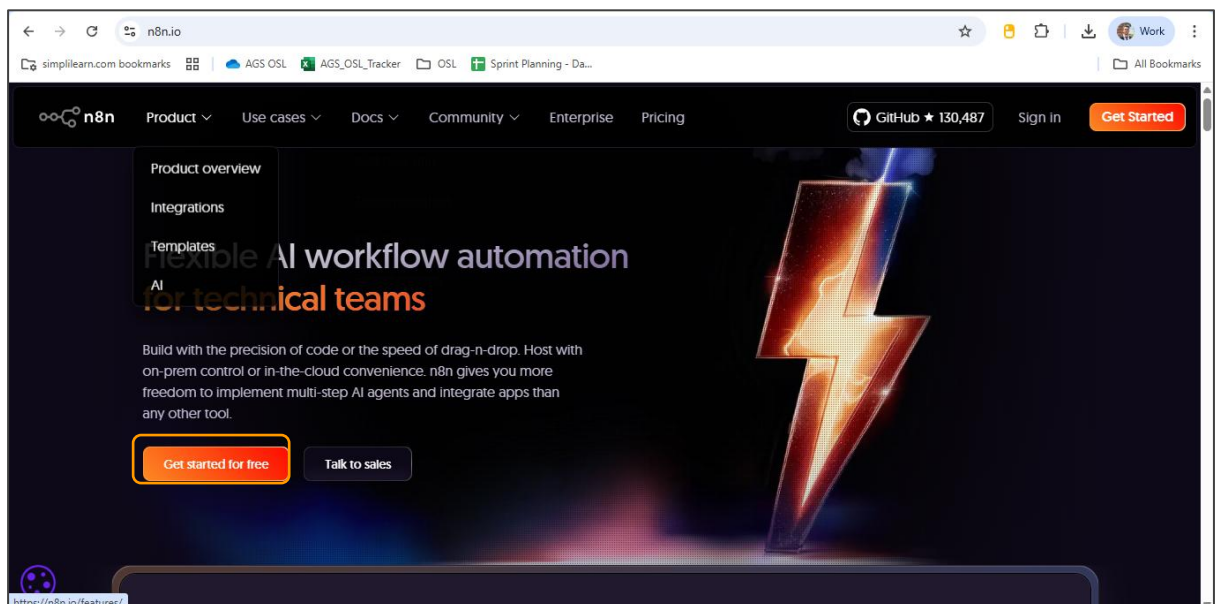
**Prerequisites:** An n8n account, a Gmail account with access to the inbox you will monitor, and a Google Sheet you can edit

### Steps to be followed:

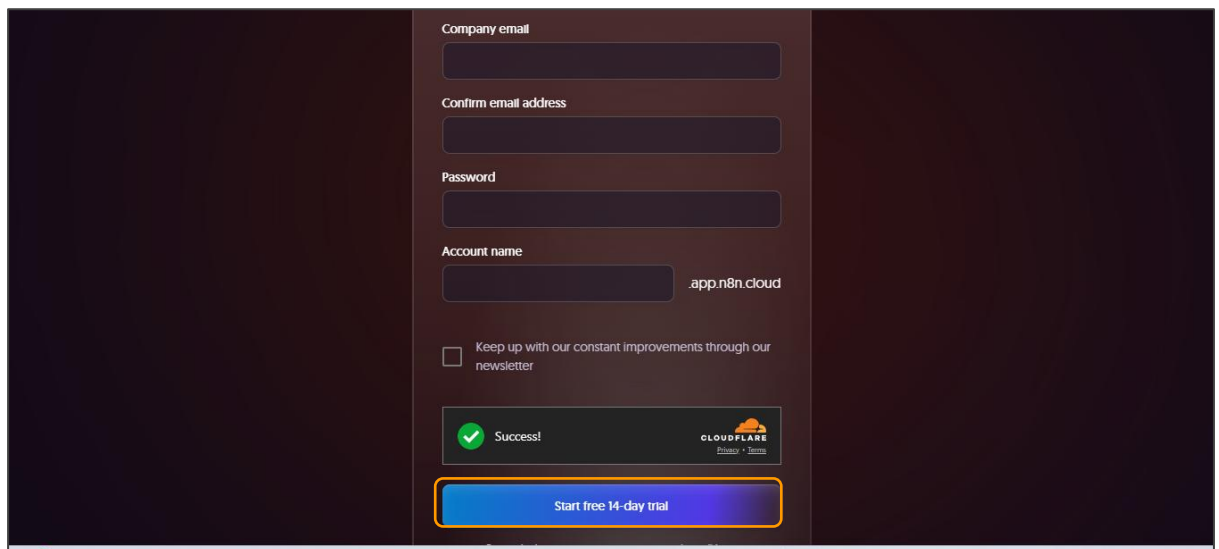
1. Set up the n8n environment
2. Create the Gmail trigger
3. Parse and prioritize the email in a Code node
4. Log tickets to Google Sheets

## Step 1: Set up the n8n environment

- 1.1 Go to [n8n.io](https://n8n.io) and click **Get started for free** to open n8n Cloud



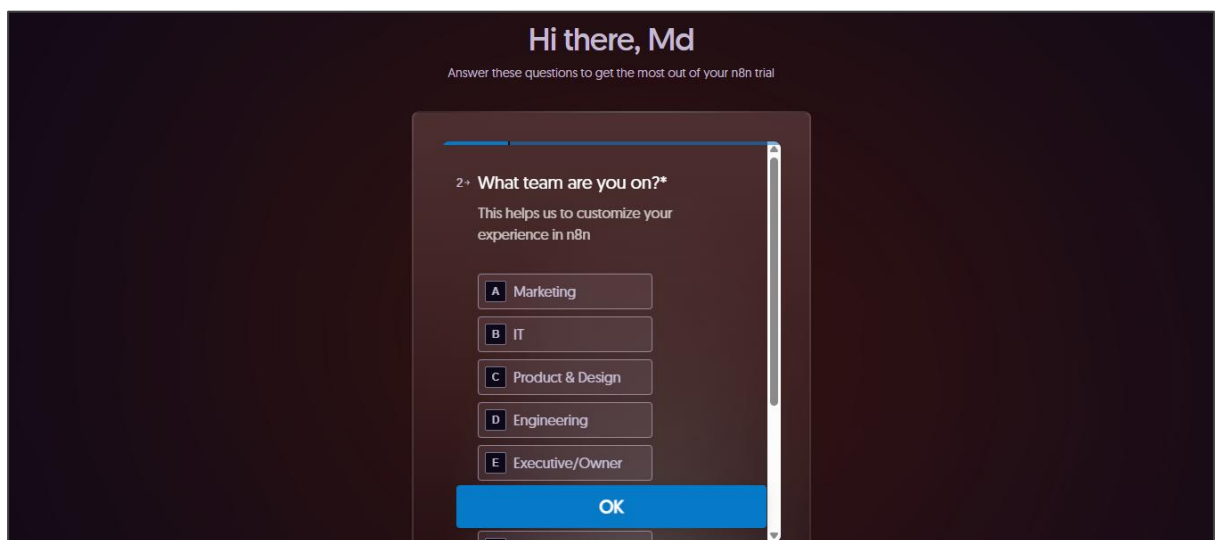
### 1.2 Enter your credentials and click **Start free 14-day trial**



Registration form for n8n trial. The form is centered on a dark background. It contains the following fields and elements:

- Company email:** A text input field.
- Confirm email address:** A text input field.
- Password:** A text input field.
- Account name:** A text input field with the placeholder text ".app.n8n.cloud".
- ☐ Keep up with our constant improvements through our newsletter
- Success!** message with a green checkmark icon and the Cloudflare logo.
- Start free 14-day trial** button: A blue button with a yellow border.

### 1.3 Answer the onboarding questions to proceed

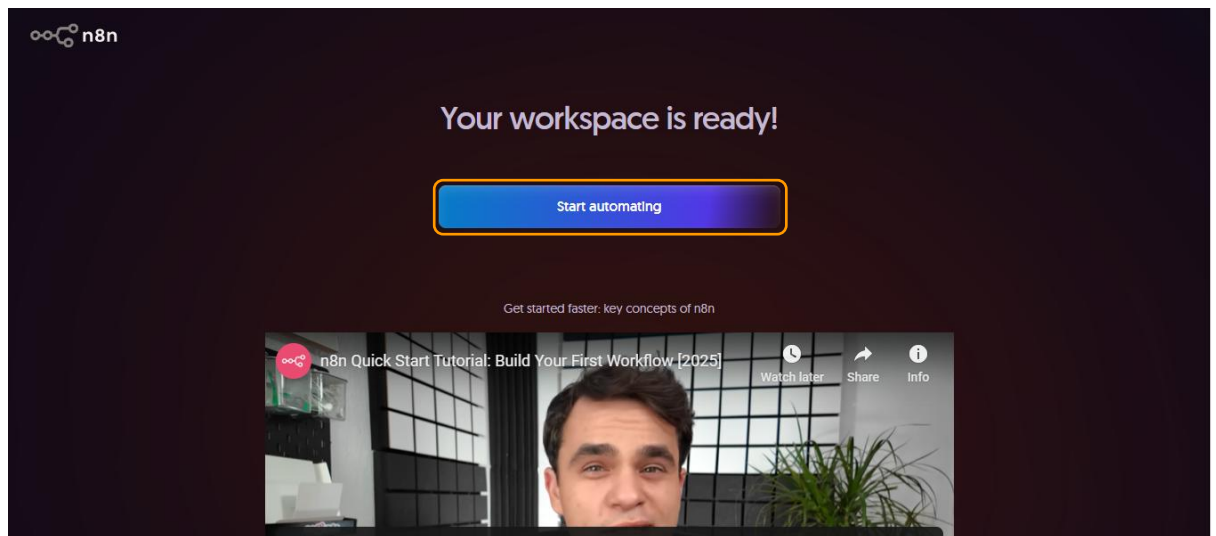


Onboarding screen titled "Hi there, Md" with the subtitle "Answer these questions to get the most out of your n8n trial". The screen displays a question: "2- What team are you on?\*" with the instruction "This helps us to customize your experience in n8n". The question is followed by five radio button options:

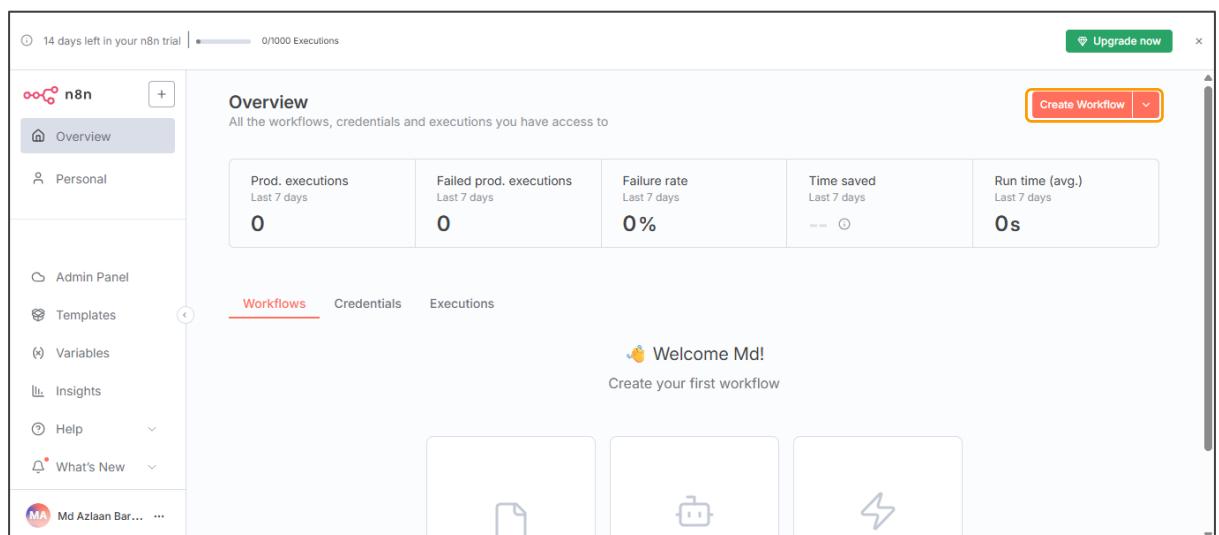
- ☐ A Marketing
- ☐ B IT
- ☐ C Product & Design
- ☐ D Engineering
- ☐ E Executive/Owner

At the bottom of the form is a blue **OK** button.

1.4 After answering the questions, click **Start automating**

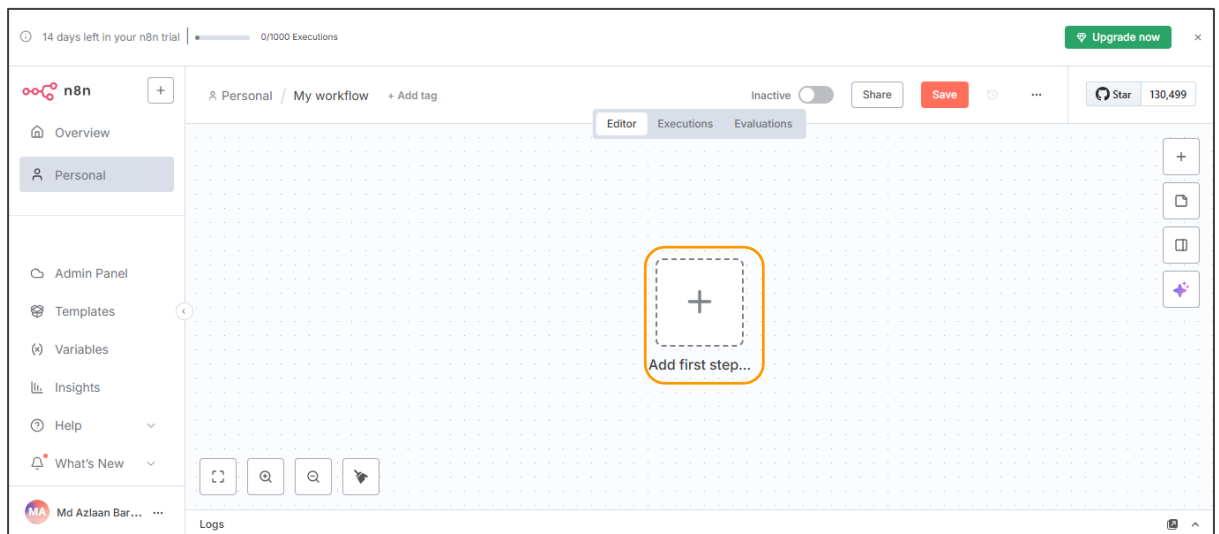


1.5 You will be directed to the n8n dashboard; click **Create Workflow**.

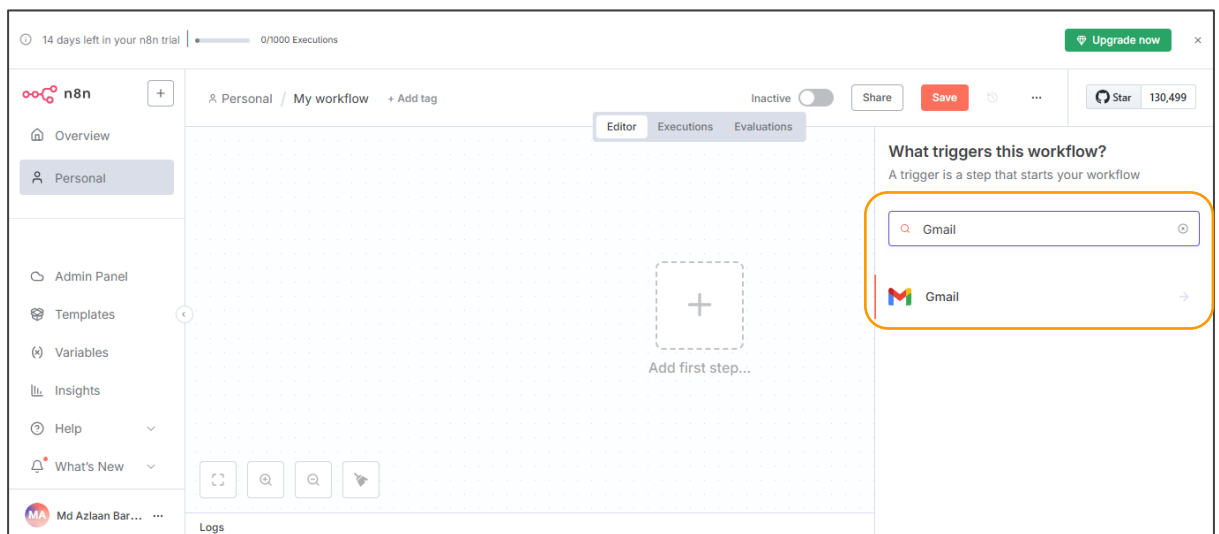


## Step 2: Create the Email Trigger

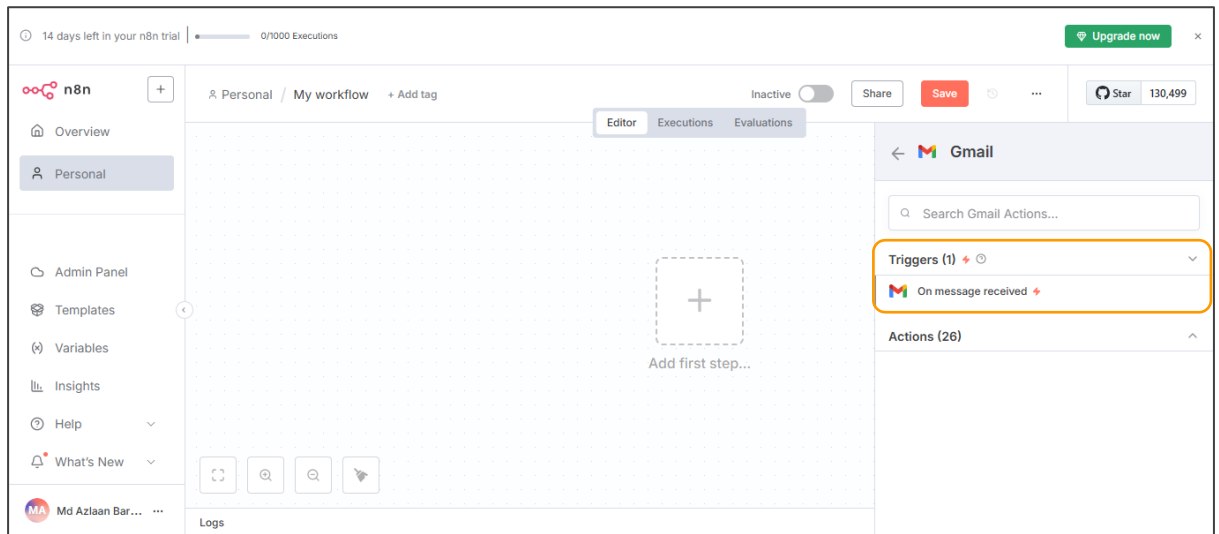
### 2.1 On the n8n canvas, click +



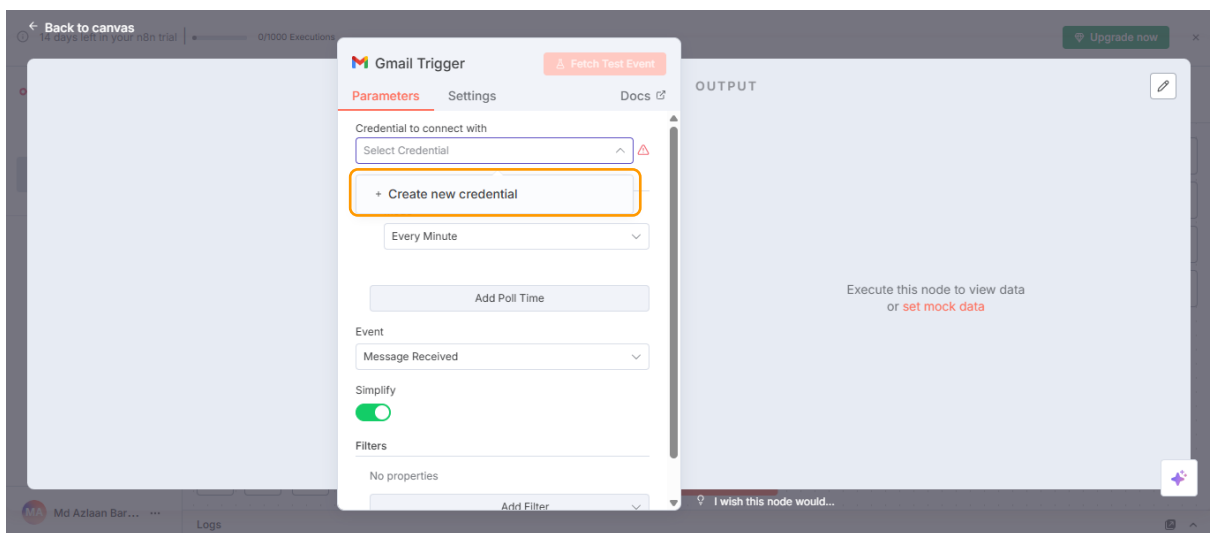
### 2.2 A panel from the right will open; search Gmail and select the **Gmail** trigger.



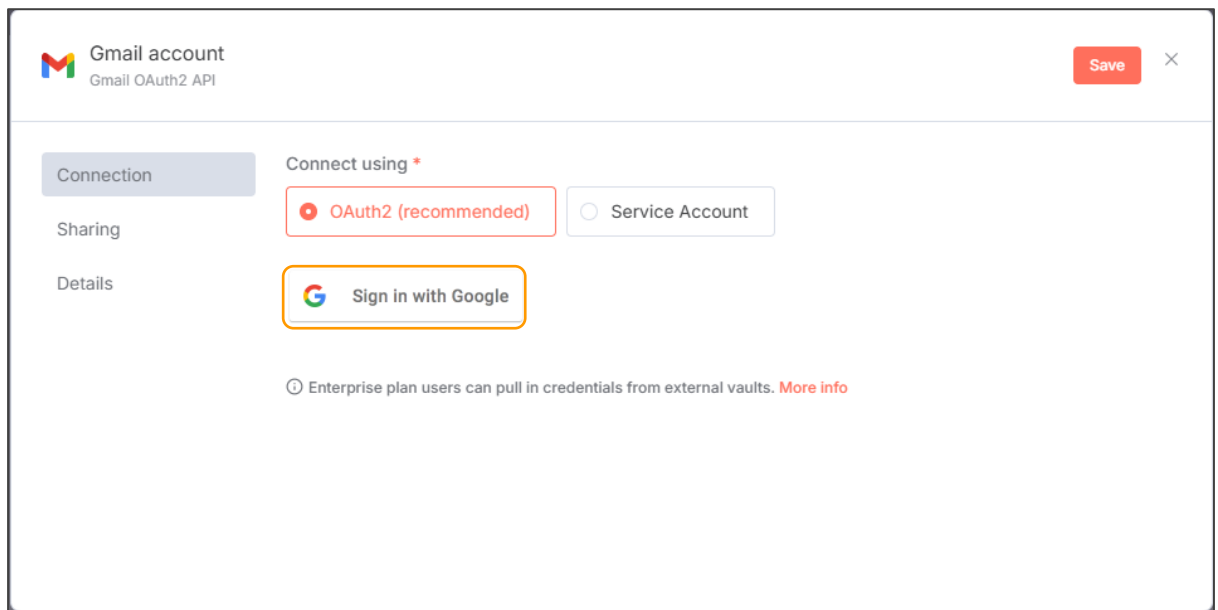
## 2.3 In the Trigger settings, choose **On message received** and turn **Simplify Output = ON**



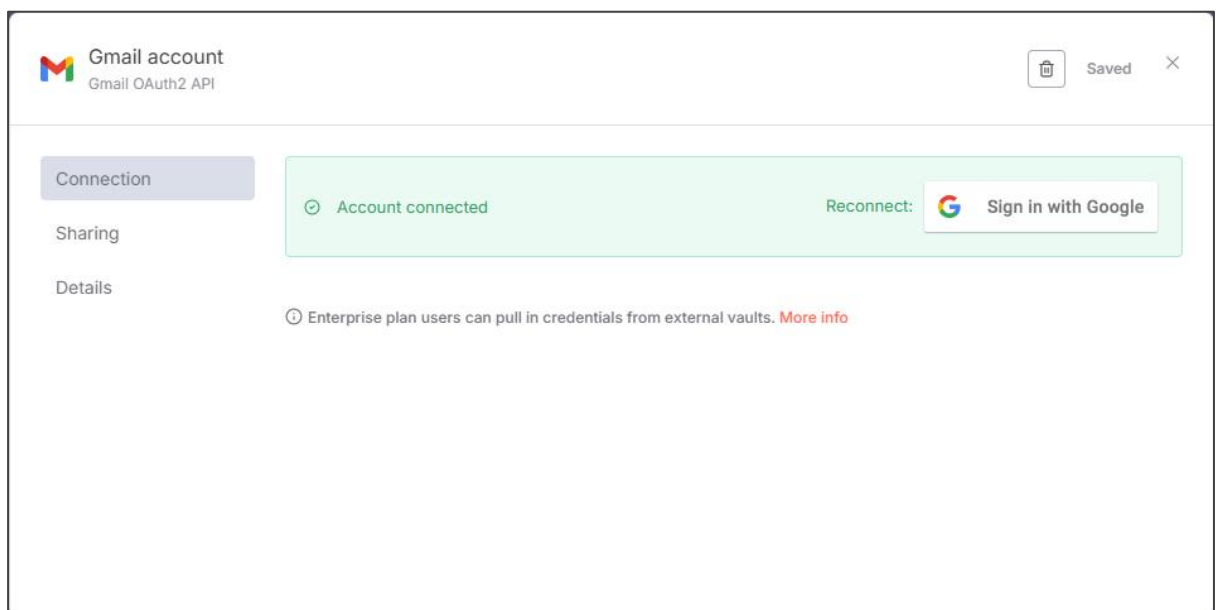
## 2.4 Click **Credentials** → **+ Create new credentials**



## 2.5 Choose **Sign in with Google** and grant the requested permissions



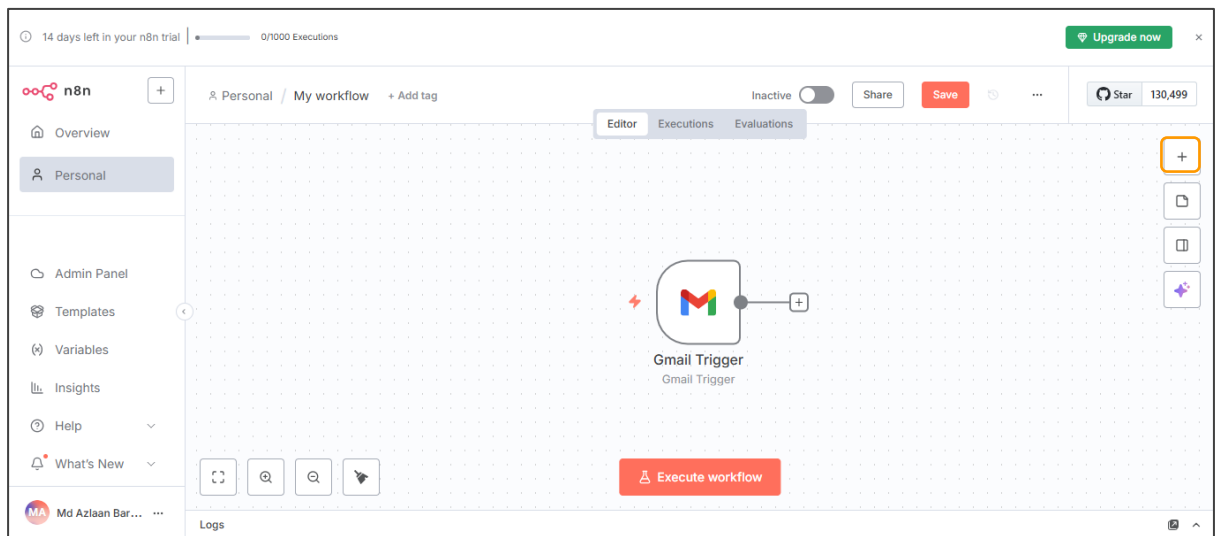
## 2.6 When you see **Account connected**, close this window to return to the workflow



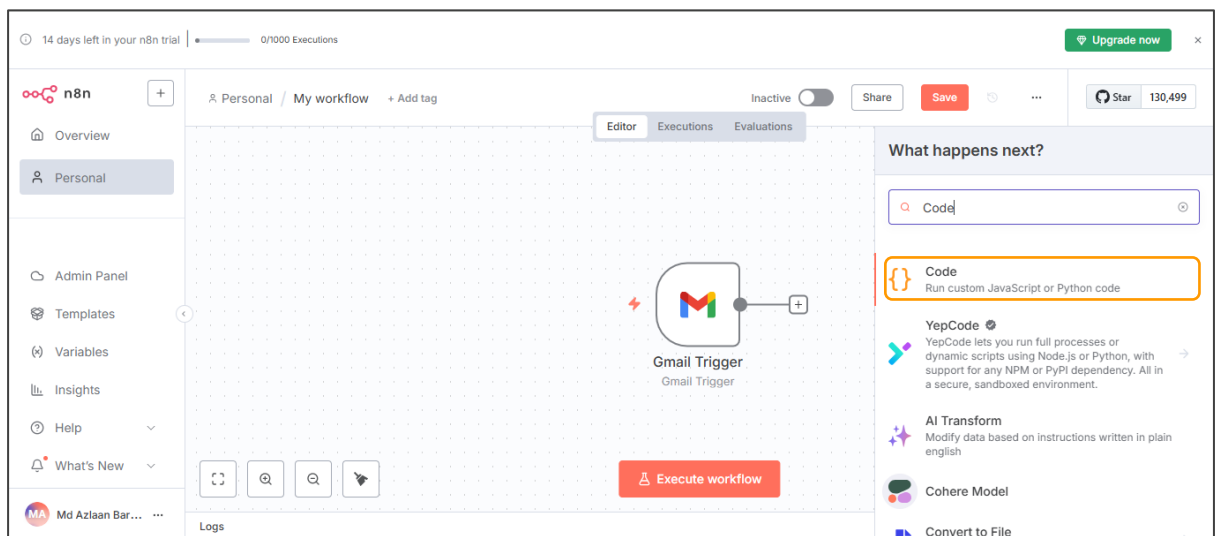
**Note:** If you see Forbidden / insufficient scopes, reconnect the credential and allow read/modify access.

## Step 3: Parse and prioritize the Email

### 3.1 Open the nodes panel by clicking the + icon



### 3.2 Search for Code, and select the {} Code option



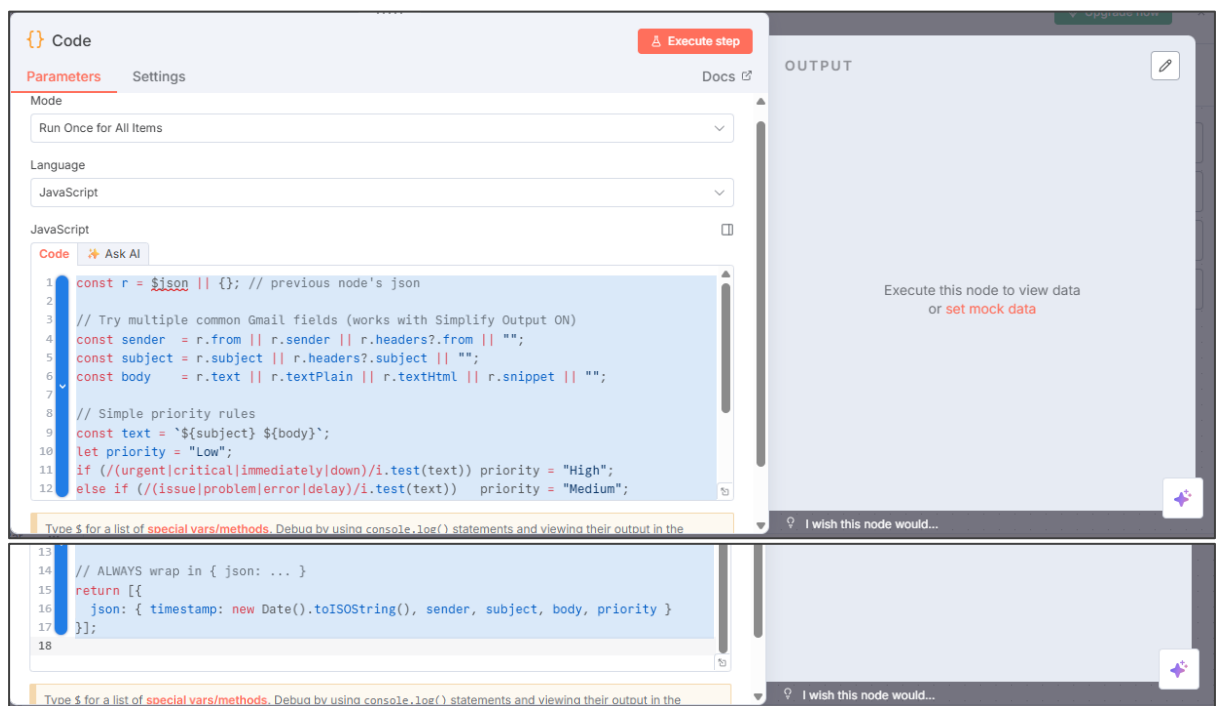
3.3 In the Code node editor, paste the following script:

```
const r = $json || {}; // previous node's json

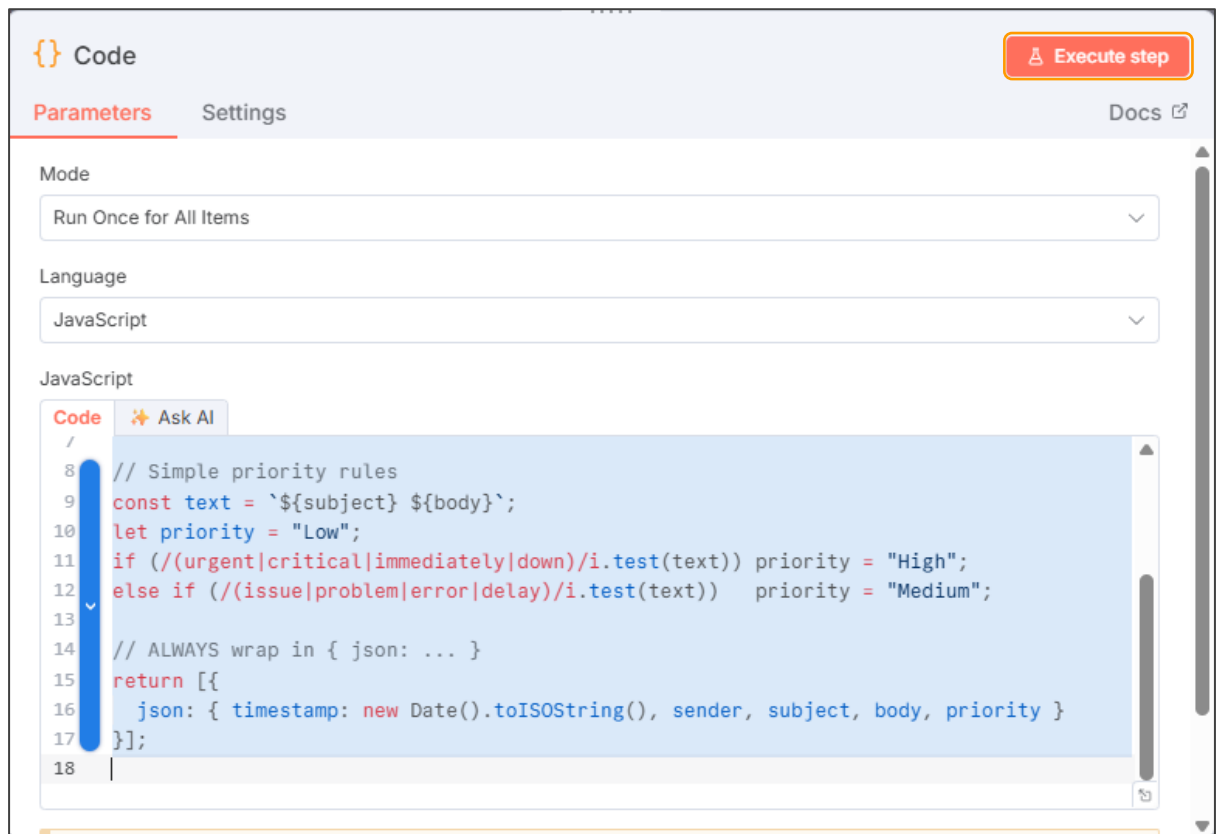
// Try multiple common Gmail fields (works with Simplify Output ON)
const sender = r.from || r.sender || r.headers?.from || "";
const subject = r.subject || r.headers?.subject || "";
const body = r.text || r.textPlain || r.textHtml || r.snippet || "";

// Simple priority rules
const text = `${subject} ${body}`;
let priority = "Low";
if (/urgent|critical|immediately|down)/i.test(text) priority = "High";
else if (/issue|problem|error|delay)/i.test(text) priority = "Medium";

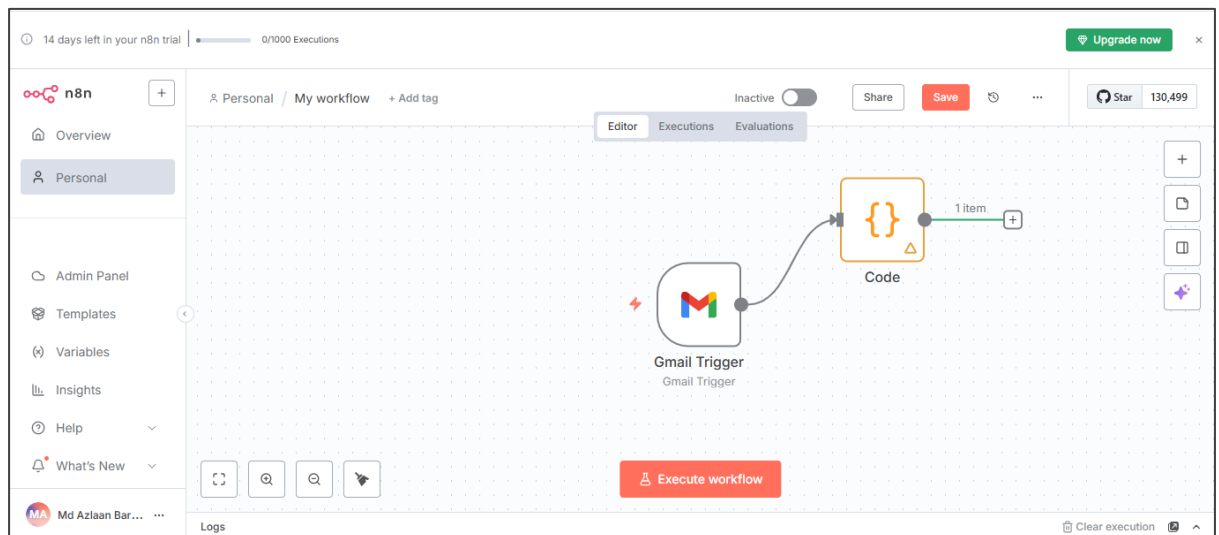
// ALWAYS wrap in { json: ... }
return [{
  json: { timestamp: new Date().toISOString(), sender, subject, body, priority }
}];
```



### 3.4 Click the **Execute step** to run the code node



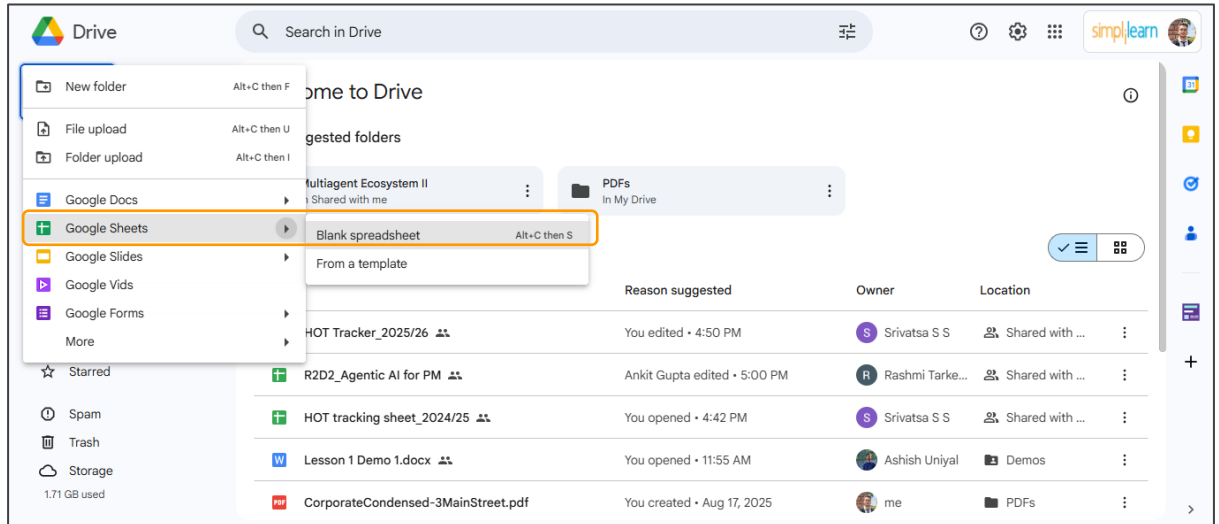
### 3.5 Return to the canvas and connect **Gmail Trigger** → **Code**



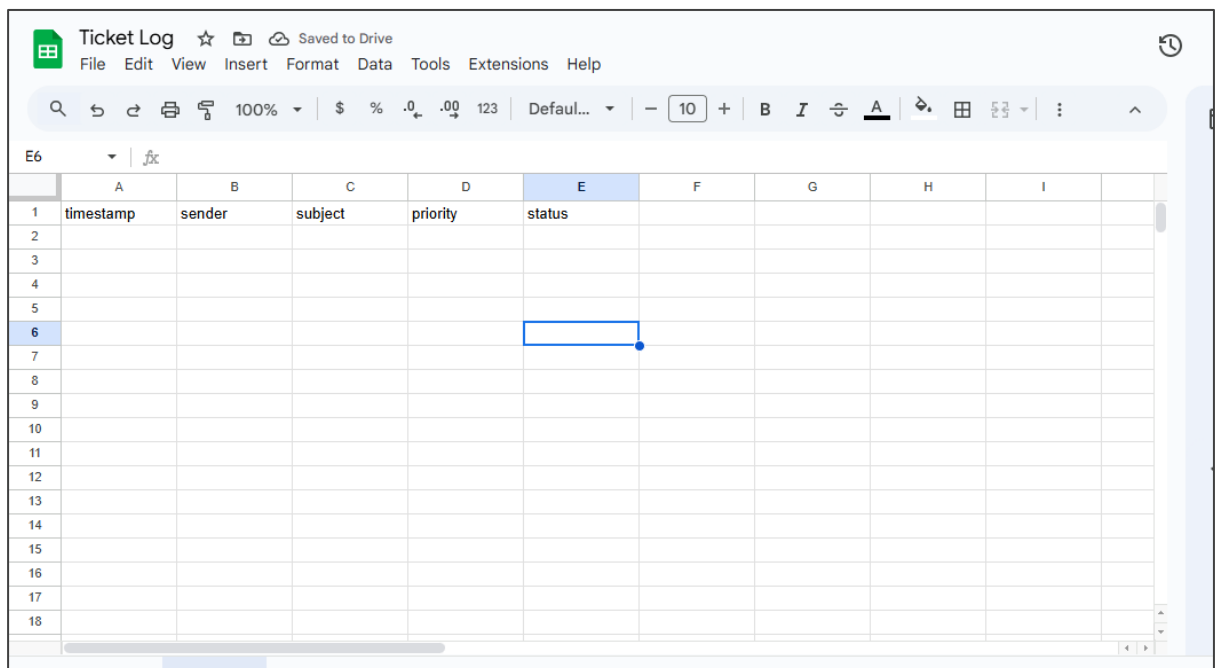
**Note:** If the Code output says, "Item is empty," re-run Execute workflow so the Gmail Trigger produces a fresh item.

## Step 4: Log tickets to Google Sheets

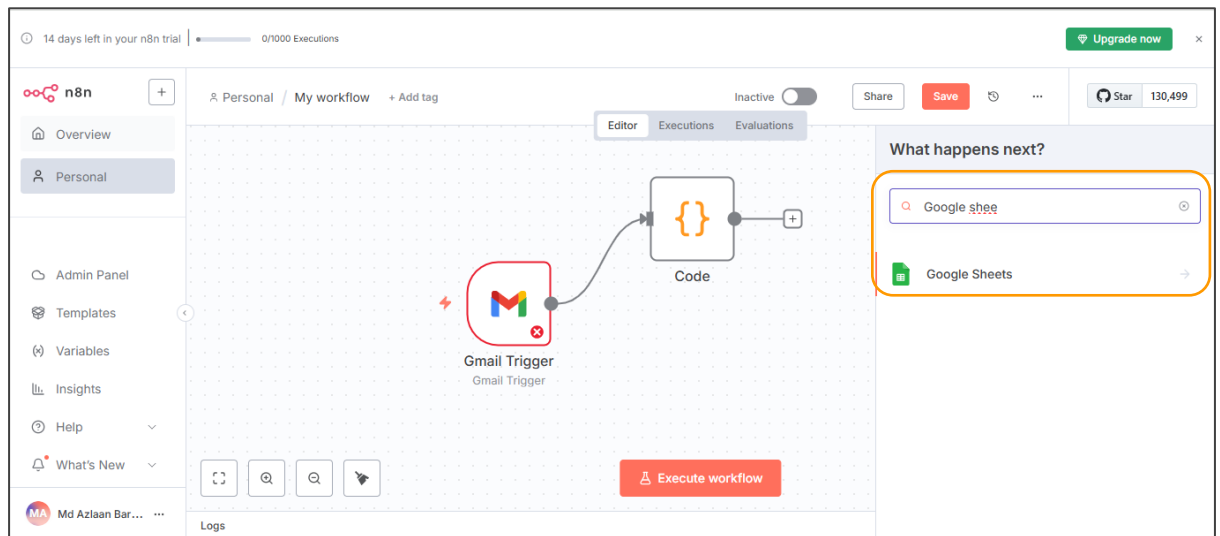
#### 4.1 In Google Drive, create a spreadsheet named **Ticket Log**



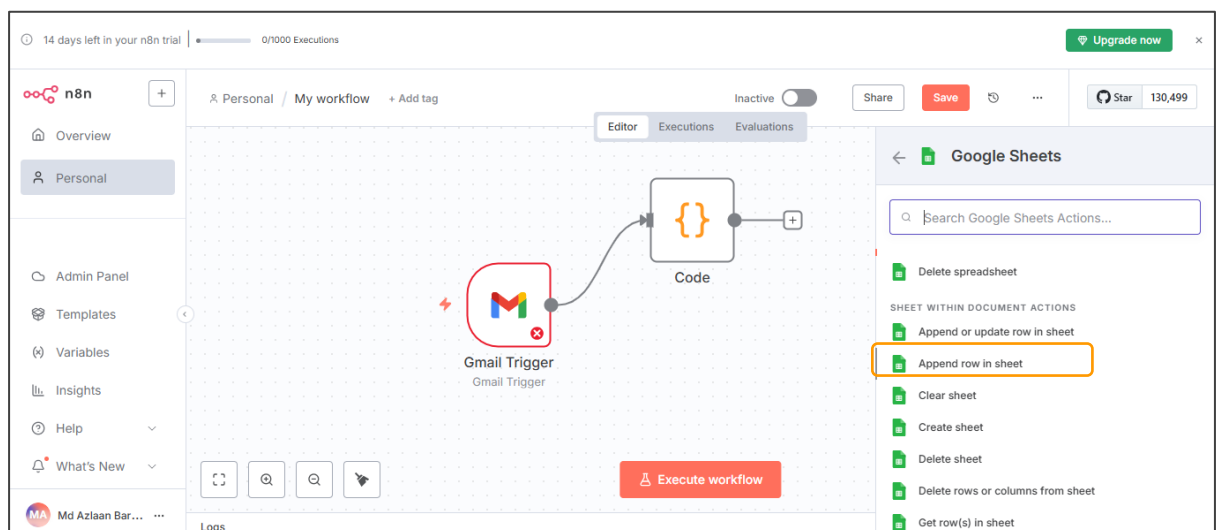
4.2 In Row 1, add the following headers: timestamp, sender, subject, priority, status



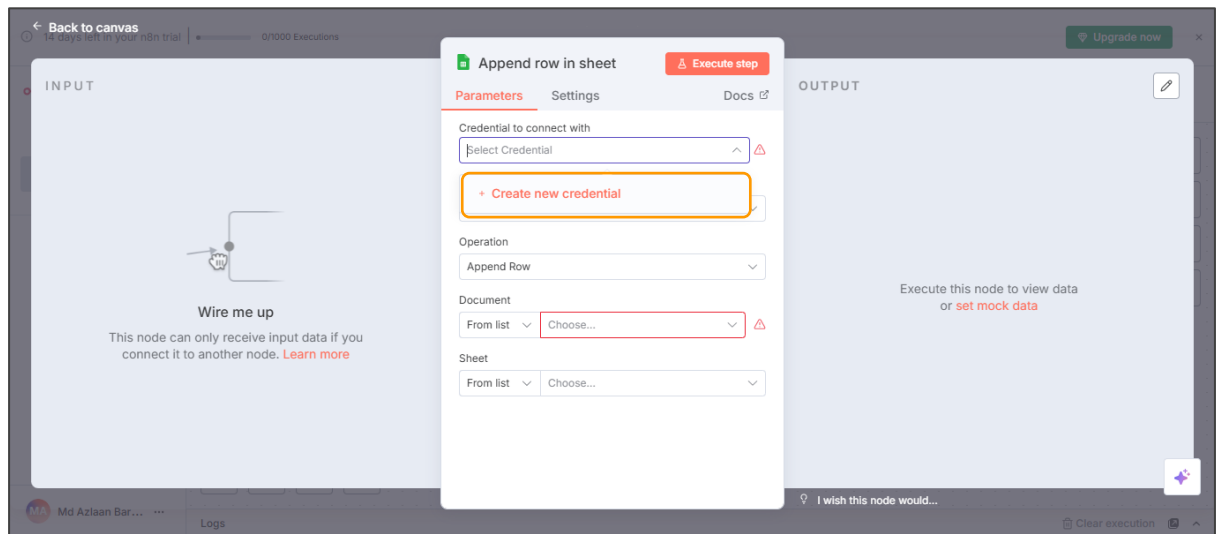
#### 4.3 Go back on the canvas, click +, search **Google Sheets** and select it



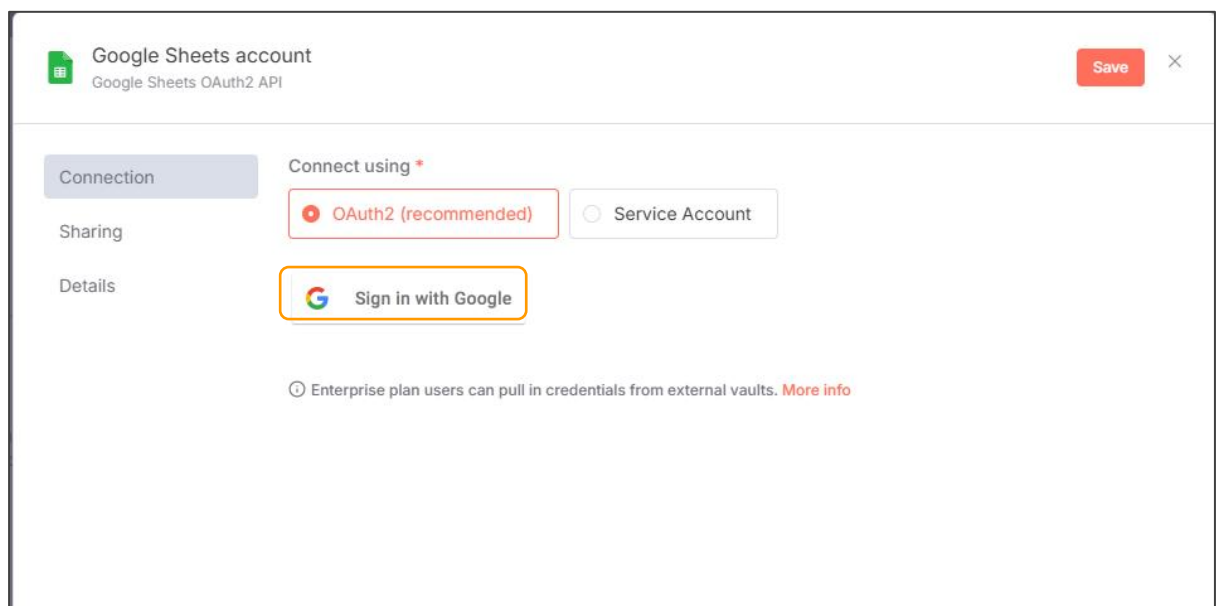
#### 4.4 Choose **Append row in sheet** from the list of options



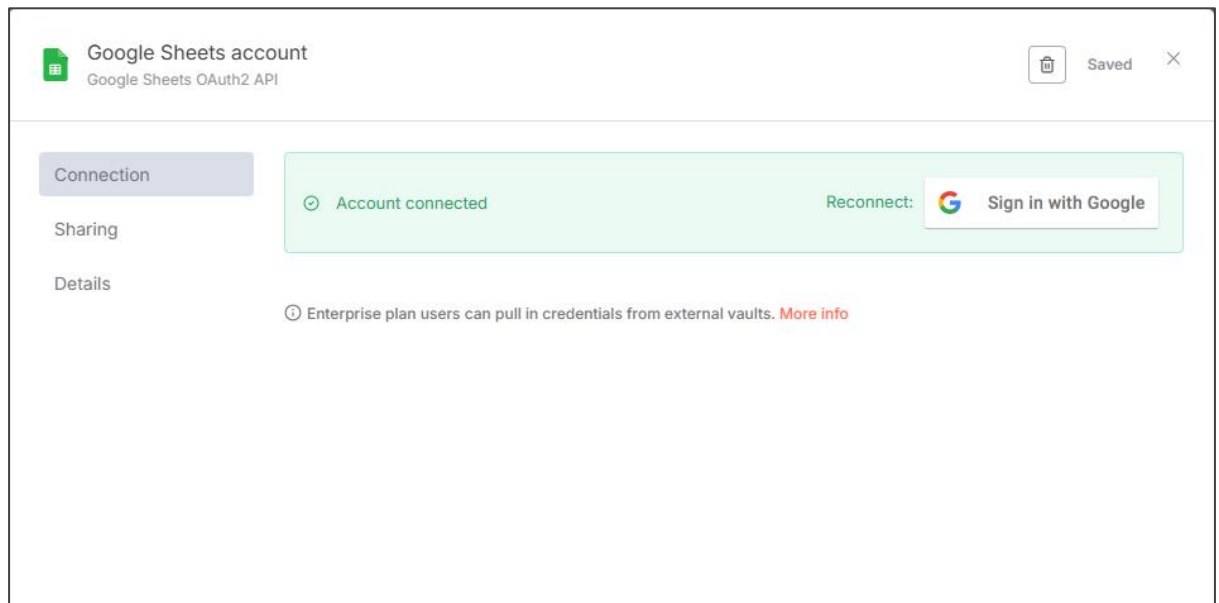
#### 4.5 Click + Create new credentials



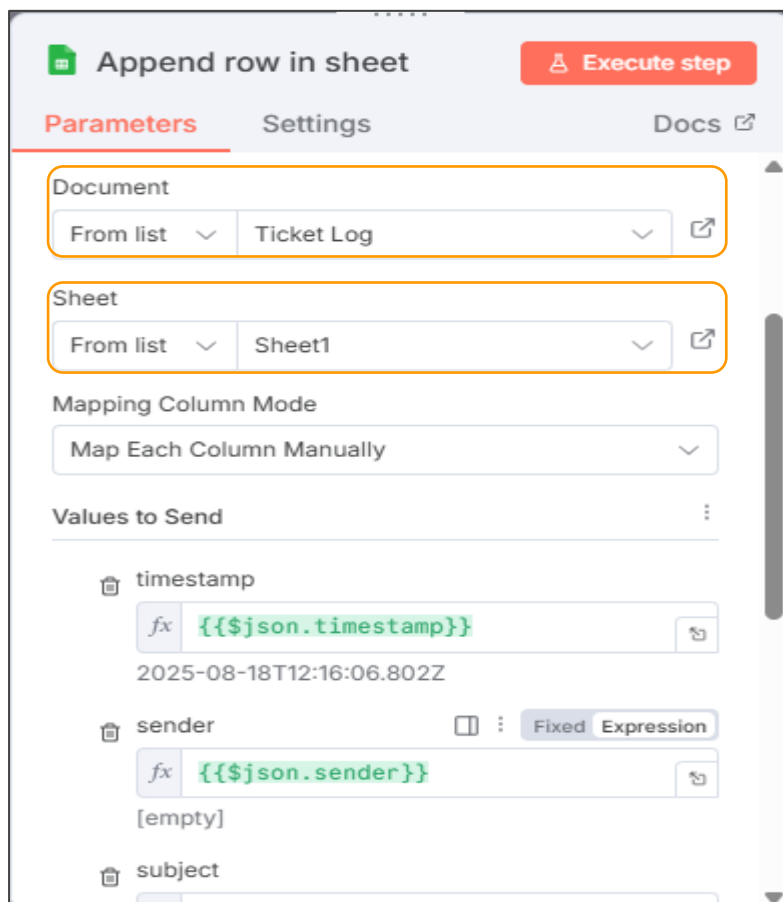
#### 4.6 Click **Sign in with Google** and grant the requested permissions



4.7 When connected, close this window to return to the node



4.8 Double-click on Google Sheets, then select the name of the sheet under the **Document** option and the sheet number under the **Sheet** option



4.9 Scroll down to the **Values to Send** section and enter the following values under each placeholder and hit **Execute step**:

Timestamp → {{\$json.timestamp}}

Sender → {{\$json.sender}}

Subject → {{\$json.subject}}

Priority → {{\$json.priority}}

Status → Logged

**Append row in sheet** Execute step

**Parameters** Settings Docs

Values to Send

timestamp Fixed Expression

fx {{\$json.timestamp}} Focus parameter

2025-08-18T12:16:06.802Z

sender

fx {{\$json.sender}}

[empty]

subject

fx {{\$json.subject}}

[empty]

priority

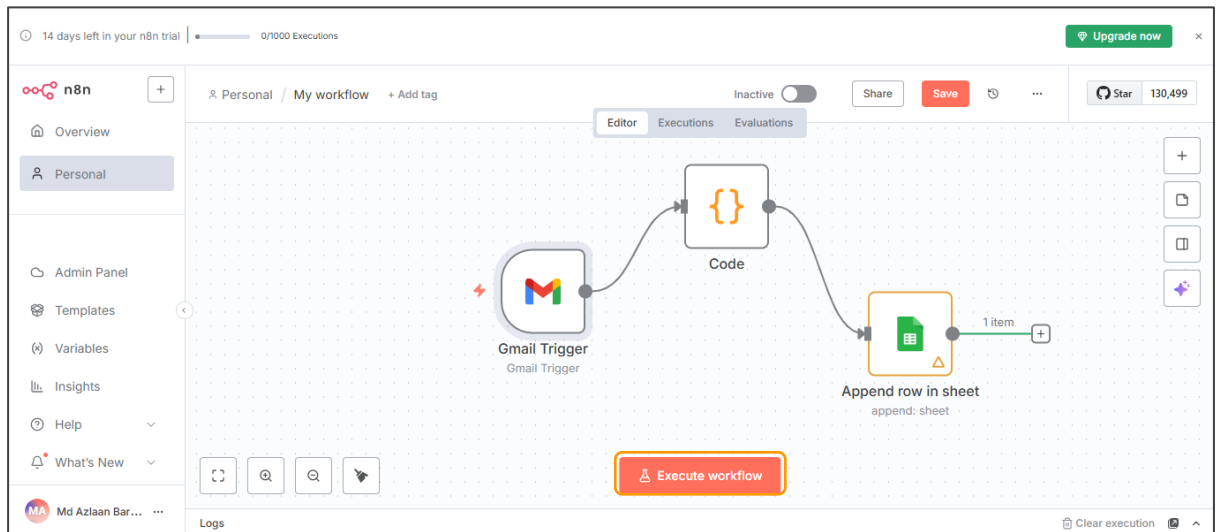
fx {{\$json.priority}}

Low

status

Logged

#### 4.10 Return to the canvas, connect **Code** → **Google Sheets (Append row in sheet)**, and click **Execute workflow**



**Note:** After you click Execute workflow, send test emails and verify if a new row appears in Ticket Log; if not, re-run to refresh Gmail input and check Google Sheets mappings and credentials.

By following these steps, you have successfully set up n8n ticket routing that collects support emails, sets priority, and appends to a Google Sheet, improving response times by auto-logging and surfacing high-priority tickets.